# CONNECT DAILY

Monday 9 November 2026
themapsproject.com

*A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.*

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

## TOP LINE

- Sheffield's Talbot Specialist School - a council-run SEND school - saw NEU members walk out on 5 November, with further strike days threatened across the month in a dispute over workload and safe working practices.

  → **For your school:** *Worth noting if AP/SEND placement conversations touch Talbot's capacity over the coming weeks.*

- Otherwise another quiet 24-48 hours nationally - no new DfE, Ofsted, safeguarding or funding story cleared the corroboration bar, so today's edition stays short rather than padded.
- Reminder: DfE's call for evidence on exclusion reform closes in 10 days, on 19 November.

## DATES FOR THE DIARY

**19 Nov 2026** — DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform (behaviour strategies, in-school units, managed moves) closes - 10 days away.

**Nov 2026 (exact day tbc)** — DfE due to publish autumn 2025/26 suspensions and permanent exclusions statistics for England.

## SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

- **NEU strike action hits Talbot Specialist School.** Staff at Talbot Specialist School - one of the few Sheffield schools still maintained directly by the council rather than a trust - walked out on Thursday 5 November, with the NEU threatening several more strike days across November. The union cites excessive workload and unsafe working practices; the council has asked members to reconsider. (The Star (Sheffield))

  → **For your school:** *Flag to the inclusion team if ongoing disruption affects SEND placement or referral capacity at Talbot over the coming weeks.*

## BEHAVIOUR & EXCLUSIONS

- **Exclusion reform feedback window narrows.** DfE's call for evidence on exclusion reform - covering behaviour strategies, in-school units and managed moves - closes in 10 days, on 19 November. The accompanying autumn 2025/26 suspensions and permanent exclusions statistics are still due this month, with no exact publication date confirmed yet. (Local Government Lawyer / GOV.UK)

  → **For your school:** *Last call for the inclusion team to get any evidence in before the window closes.*

## FROM THE CORRIDOR

*Failing to engage in meaningful dialogue.*

Rafia Hussain, NEU Sheffield branch secretary, on the Talbot dispute

## MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

**School+** is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

## SOURCES MONITORED

*Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.*

| Source | Type | What we track |
|---|---|---|
| **OFFICIAL & STATUTORY** | | |
| DfE / GOV.UK | Government | Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics |
| Ofsted | Government | Inspection framework, report cards, annual report |
| Explore Education Statistics | Government data | Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data |
| House of Commons Library | Parliament | Neutral briefings on bills and policy |
| **RESEARCH & EVIDENCE** | | |
| Education Endowment Foundation | Research | Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching |
| NFER | Research | Assessment, workforce, disadvantage |
| Education Policy Institute | Think tank | Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap |
| Institute for Fiscal Studies | Think tank | School funding and spending analysis |
| FFT Education Datalab | Data analysis | Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions |
| **INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS** | | |
| The Difference | Charity | Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?" |
| IPPR | Think tank | Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform |
| Youth Endowment Fund | Research | What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion |
| Centre for Social Justice | Think tank | Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy |
| Whole School SEND | Network | SEND practice, resources and reviews |
| **SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY** | | |
| Schools Week | Press | Breaking sector news and investigations |
| Tes | Press | Practice, policy and workforce |
| The Guardian (Education) | Press | National coverage and comment |
| X (monitored) | Social | DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use |
| **LOCAL & REGIONAL** | | |
| The Star (Sheffield) | Local press | Local schools and Ofsted outcomes |
| Sheffield City Council | Local government | Council decisions, funding and local strategy |
| South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub | Regional | Regional skills, careers and funding |

**Connect Daily** is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

*For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.*